

To the Screening Authority,

Statement signed 28 September 2026, supplied with my application.

I am writing this myself because a list of dates makes me sound like I have done nothing between the bad ones. I know I have to explain them, and I am not asking for them to disappear. I want the paid assistant coaching job because I have liked being useful at the junior club. I also know that wanting a job does not answer the questions about my past.

I was born Callum James Byrne in Christchurch on 17 August 1994. I moved to Australia on 2 February 2012, when I was seventeen, using my New Zealand passport. At first I lived with relatives and did casual stores work. I did not come over on a student visa. My entry was on the Special Category visa, subclass 444. I became an Australian citizen at the Palmerston ceremony on 26 January 2020.

The surname Hartigan is my mother's family name, which I took after becoming estranged from my father.

The change was registered with NT Births, Deaths and Marriages on 3 May 2019. I used Byrne at the old employer and on the 2017 court papers. My current licence and citizenship certificate say Hartigan. My New Zealand passport still says Byrne, which is why I included the name-change paper. I have not been trying to keep a second identity.

I work early starts at Arafura Freight Logistics and am usually home before the afternoon heat drops. I am a shift supervisor, not the depot manager. My job is to sort the loading order and check paperwork with the drivers. If a pallet is wrong, I cannot make it right by shouting at someone. That took me longer to learn than it should have.

I am applying for a few hours of coaching alongside my full-time job. I like the ordinary bits: putting out cones, counting bibs and making sure everyone has water. The association has explained the head-coach arrangement. I have agreed to it and I do not expect to start a session by myself.

In 2011 I got caught shoplifting in Christchurch. I was sixteen. I took things from a shop with another boy because we thought it was clever and because I wanted to go along with him. The Youth Court diversion was completed and no conviction was recorded. I mention it because I was asked for the whole history, not just the Australian part. I have enclosed the New Zealand record rather than asking you to trust my memory of its wording.

The Darwin assault happened outside a nightclub on 12 November 2016. I had been drinking for several hours. There was an argument at the exit and I punched a man in the face. His nose was broken. He was not a child and I did not know him before that evening. I pleaded guilty at the Local Court and the conviction is mine. Saying that alcohol was involved is an explanation of the evening, not a reason why somebody else should have had to put up with it.

The court sentenced me on 3 April 2017 to eight months imprisonment wholly suspended and a twelve-month good behaviour bond. I completed the bond without a breach. I was frightened by the idea that I could actually go to prison, but I also knew that being frightened after hurting someone did not fix the harm. The compensation and the apology were dealt with through the court process. I did not contact the man again.

I stopped going to that strip of nightclubs. My social life now is usually a meal at home or helping at weekend sport. I have not had another assault charge. I do still get annoyed, and I think a statement saying I am never angry would be false. I try to leave an argument before I get stuck in proving I am right.

I accept that the injury was serious. I cannot tell you how he thinks about it now, and none of my references can tell you that either. The remarks are included because they describe what was accepted in court.

The warning at Stuart Highway Building Supplies in 2019 was another time I let an argument go too far. A co-worker and I argued over who had put a delivery in the wrong bay. I shouted and threw a clipboard towards the ground beside the pallet stack. No one was hit. At the time I kept saying he had started the argument. I can see now that it did not change what I did with the clipboard.

The supervisor told us to leave the yard separately and gave me a written warning. I signed the receipt of it. I did not like the wording about intimidation, because I thought I was being called something worse than the event. That is what I thought then. I understand that somebody seeing a grown man throw something does not know what he is going to throw next. The warning was not a police charge and I have included it anyway.

At Arafura Freight the process is clearer. If I think a bay instruction is wrong, I mark the docket and go to the manager. It takes longer than telling everyone my version, but then someone has the paperwork. I have had disagreements at this workplace and have not thrown anything or threatened a co-worker. My manager can describe what she has seen there. She was not at the building supplies yard in 2019.

I kept the old personnel extract because I knew it would look dishonest if I described only the conviction and said everything else was perfect. I do not think the three events are all the same, but I understand why you would put them beside each other. A wall, a clipboard and a punch are different acts; each of them happened when I was angry.

Most of the days between were normal workdays. That is not a defence. It is why I have sent time sheets and letters from people who have been around me for more than one good afternoon. I cannot promise that every referee has watched me in every sort of argument.

In March 2021 Jessica Tran and I had an argument at the Moulden house about money and whether I was going to move out. I punched a hole in a hallway wall. I did not hit Jessica, but I understand that hitting the wall was frightening. Police attended and made a domestic violence order. I did not contest the order. It ran for twelve months and I followed it. I did not receive a breach charge or another charge from that incident.

Jessica's daughter was at her grandmother's in Palmerston that night and never saw any of it.

I am putting that sentence in because I have been asked about whether children were involved. I did not go into the child's room during the argument. I do not want to approach Jessica or her family to get a letter for this application. Our relationship ended and I think leaving them alone is the respectful thing to do. If screening needs something from the police record, I would rather you ask through the proper process.

The relationship ended, and we kept our later arrangements separate. The order did not mean I was convicted of assaulting Jessica. I also know that being able to say there was no conviction does not mean the wall was harmless. I paid for the repair through the landlord. I have not included a repair invoice because I do not still have it. I did not use that missing invoice to ask for the incident to be removed from the record.

I remember being embarrassed about the neighbours hearing us. That was not the part I should have worried about most. I was thinking about being judged instead of what it would feel like to be in the house. It took the group sessions for me to say that plainly. I still dislike reading the police description, and my account above is my own recollection. I am not asking anyone to treat my recollection as a court finding.

I have provided the order and the incident extract in the form they were supplied to me.

I went to Top End Men's Pathways from September 2021 through March 2022. It was not enjoyable. For the first few meetings I sat there thinking some of the other men had done much worse things than I had. The facilitator stopped that comparison and asked what I had done in my own house. I needed that, even though I did not appreciate it at the time.

One thing I remember is the exercise about an argument having more than one stopping point. I used to describe anger as if it came from nowhere. We had to write down the point when we raised our voice, moved closer, followed someone into another room or started talking over them. When I put those steps down, the hole in the wall stopped looking like a single accident. I had chances to stop before it.

I attended the program and have supplied both the certificate and the facilitator's report. I do not keep my own roll book and I have left their dates as issued. I missed two ordinary meetings because of work arrangements and attended the make-up meetings arranged by the service. I am not asking the certificate to mean that nobody has to assess anything else.

My practical rule now is to stop a conversation if I am raising my voice, say I need time, and come back at an agreed time. I use it at work more often than in my private life. I do not have a partner currently and I have not had the same situation as living through a relationship ending. I think it would be false to say the course has tested me in every circumstance.

I reduced drinking after 2016 and generally avoid it when I am tired or upset. I have not supplied a clinical assessment of alcohol use and I am not claiming to have a medical diagnosis. I can only tell you what I do. I do not drink before work or football. The program letter is from the facilitator, not a doctor's report about my future behaviour.

The volunteer work in 2024 and 2025 was with Palmerston Magpies Junior Club. Tessa ran the training. I put out the equipment and helped the children repeat drills. The important part was learning how much repetition children need without making the repetition their fault. Some of them would look away halfway through an explanation and then do exactly the same thing again. Tessa would show it once more, and I followed that.

I assisted in two full club seasons without any reported incident about my conduct.

The club has sent its incident log. It contains ankle injuries, late collection and the sort of things volunteers write down so that the next person knows what happened. I cannot claim a blank record of every child's feelings. I can say I was not called in about a complaint against me and I have not been told of one.

I never drove a child home and I did not send private messages to the children. If a parent asked me about a place on a team I sent them to the head coach. I have a loud warehouse voice, and Tessa told me early on to stand closer to the group and use a normal voice rather than calling across the field. I did that. It was ordinary coaching advice, not a disciplinary matter.

My five references come from different parts of my life. Samuel has known me since childhood. Moira saw the pack-up work at the club. Devika sees me at work. Owen sees me at the community garden, where there are adults with different opinions about everything. Tessa supervised the junior work. I asked them to write what they know rather than all using a sample letter.

The paid role would have more responsibility than carrying cones. I accept the association's rule that a head coach is present and that I am never alone with children. I would rather lose a session payment than improvise with a child waiting after everyone else has left. I understand that this arrangement is for the pending period and is not a promise of a clearance.

I live at 14 Wirrina Court, Gray, and moved there on 1 November 2022. I keep my bills in a kitchen drawer and usually deal with forms on Sunday. That system is not impressive but it works better than leaving letters in my work bag. My current licence has not caught up with everything on my paperwork. I have included the copies as they are rather than trying to make the pages look newer.

My shifts at the warehouse start at 05:30 most weeks. Tuesday and Thursday football fits when the truck schedule does not change. The Association knows I am employed full time elsewhere. I will let the head coach know if there is overtime, because turning up late is no help when children are waiting for a drill. I do not want an appointment that relies on me hiding my main job.

I have included older bank statements because they were among the address papers requested from me. They show ordinary spending and transfers. I am not saying the transactions prove that I am suitable to work with children. I have tried to send the records requested even where they do not make the statement look tidy. If there is a question about a particular entry, please identify it so that I can answer it.

I know there is a pattern someone can see between the assault, the work argument and the wall. I think my conduct since the program is different, but I do not expect you to decide that only because I wrote it. There has been nearly a decade since the assault and several years since the order. My employer and the coach have had time to see me with rules and with other people.

I want the application considered with those years included. I also accept that you may need more information. I will answer a request sent to my email, and I will not contact Jessica or a child to try to settle a question myself.

Signed: Callum James Hartigan

Date: 28 September 2026

Contact: callum.hartigan@example.invalid